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Kade area, Central Kalahari Game Reserve, Botswana

Section Title(S)

(2) Kinship Categories and Proximity/Contact

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The combinations among 16 males and 16 females are divided into 3 kinds of dyads, i.e., male-male (117 dyads*[6]), male-female (256 dyads), and female-female (120 dyads). Each kind of dyad is classified into the following 4 categories of kinship:

1) Consanguines: The dyads for which the consanguineous relation were ascertained to exist. Parent-child, siblings (including half-sibling), grandparent-grandchild, uncle/aunt-nephew/niece, etc.

2) Primary affines: The dyads of residents between whom the genealogical distance includes only one conjugal linkage. The whole of ego's spouse's consanguines or ego's consanguines' spouses or the whole of consanguines of those spouses.

3) Secondary affines: The dyads of residents between whom the genealogical distance includes 2 conjugal linkages. Ego's spouse's consanguines' spouses, and the whole of consanguines of those spouses, etc.

4) Non-kins: Affines occupying more distant genealogical position than secondary affines. Namely, the dyads of residents between whom the genealogical distance includes 3 or more conjugal linkages.

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If the category of consanguines overlaps with the category of affines, the dyads belonging to both categories are regarded as consanguines, except when the affinal relationship is an immediate 'in-law' relationship between ego and ego's spouse's parents or siblings. In the latter case the dyads

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belonging to both consanguineous and affinal categories are regarded as primary affines.

Organization And Analysis Of Results

Table 9 shows the total numbers of male-male, male-female, and female-female dyads in proximity or in contact in each category. The expected number of dyads in proximity or in contact in each category were calculated according to the percentages of the total number of dyads included by 4 kinship categories. Eleven spouse dyads were excluded from the male-female dyads.

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In the male-male dyads, proximity occurs irrespective of kinship categories. Contact is apt to occur among consanguines, and shows a weak tendency not to occur among secondary affines. On the other hand, both proximity and contact is significantly frequent in consanguine female-female dyads (X^2=8.4500, p&0.01 for proximity; X^2=22.2041, p&0.001 for contact). In contrast, for the female-female dyads belonging to the non-kin category, both contact and proximity is significantly infrequent (X^2=5.2246 for proximity, X^2=3.2666 for contact, p&0.05 for both).

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In male-female dyads, almost the same tendency is noted as in the female-female dyads. Namely, both proximity and contact are significantly frequent among consanguines, and very rare among the non-kins. Proximity is also frequent among primary affines.

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The above results evidence the following points: males are apt to be proximate with each other irrespectively of kinship, while females tend to be proximate with other females of close kin. Between males and females, proximity is also apt to occur among close kin. As for contact, the preference for consanguines is evident even between males.

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Next, the kinship relations within the categories of consanguines or primary affines are specified, and the numbers of dyads in proximity or in contact in each kinship relation are compared between male-male, male-female, and female-female dyads (Table 10). As for sibling relations, there is a weak tendency for proximity to occur more often in female-female dyads (sisters) than in male-female dyads (brother-sister) (Fisher exact probability 27

Table 9. Distribution of the number of dyads for which proximity or contact was observed at least once among kinship categories

Figures in parentheses inducate the percentage to the total number in each column. '+' or '-' shows that the observed frequency of dyads in each cell is significantly greater or smaller than the expectation; +++, ---: p&0.001; ++, --: p&0.01; +, -: p&0.05; df=1.

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Kinship categories	Number of dyads	Dyads in proximity	Dyads in contact
Male-male dyads			
Consanguines	20(17.1)	15(22.1)	14(33.3)+
Primary affines	30(25.6)	19(27.9)	12(28.6)-
Secondary affines	33(28.2)	18(26.5)	5(11.9)
Non-kins	34(29.1)	16(23.5)	11(26.2)
Total	117(100.0)	68(100.0)	42(100.0)
Significant level(x^2)	-	ns(1.9090)	0.02(10.7134)
Male-female dyads			
Consanguines	41(16.7)	29(34.9)+++	11(52.4)+++
Primary affines	60(24.5)	31(37.3)+	7(33.3)
Secondary affines	44(18.0)	11(13.3)---	1(4.8)---
Non-kins	100(40.8)	12(14.5)	2(9.5)
Total	245(100.0)	83(100.0)	21(100.0)
Significant level(x^2)	-	0.001(23.0659)	0.001(40.1115)
Female-female dyads			
Consanguines	16(13.3)	15(27.8)++	14(43.8)+++
Primary affines	38(31.7)	20(37.0)	9(28.1)
Secondary affines	30(25.0)	12(22.2)-	5(15.6)-
Non-kins	36(30.0)	7(13.0)	4(12.5)
Total	120(100.0)	54(100.0)	32(100.0)
Significant level(x^2)	-	0.01(14.333)	0.001(26.7224)

test: p=0.1362 two-tailed). As for the sibling-in-law relations, proximity is more likely to occur in brother-brother-in-law dyads than in brother-sister-in-law dyads (p=0.1904). Comparing the uncle-nephew relation with uncle-niece (or aunt-nephew) relation, the ratio of dyads in proximity is very high in both kinds of relations. This high frequency of dyads in proximity might be due to the fact that all of these relations between uncle/aunt and nephew/niece are ‘cross’ relations (i.e., relations between ego and ego's mother's brother or ego's father's sister). In other words, the principle that the joking relationship is to be applied to the uncle or aunt in ‘cross’ position, though they are belonging to the adjacent generation to ego's, may be reflected in the above result.

*6 All combinations of the 16 males represent 120 dyads, but 3 males, AM, KR-12, and HO-13, had never been measured as focal individuals. Therefore the combinations among these 3 individuals cannot be observed. Thus these 3 dyads are excluded from the analysis